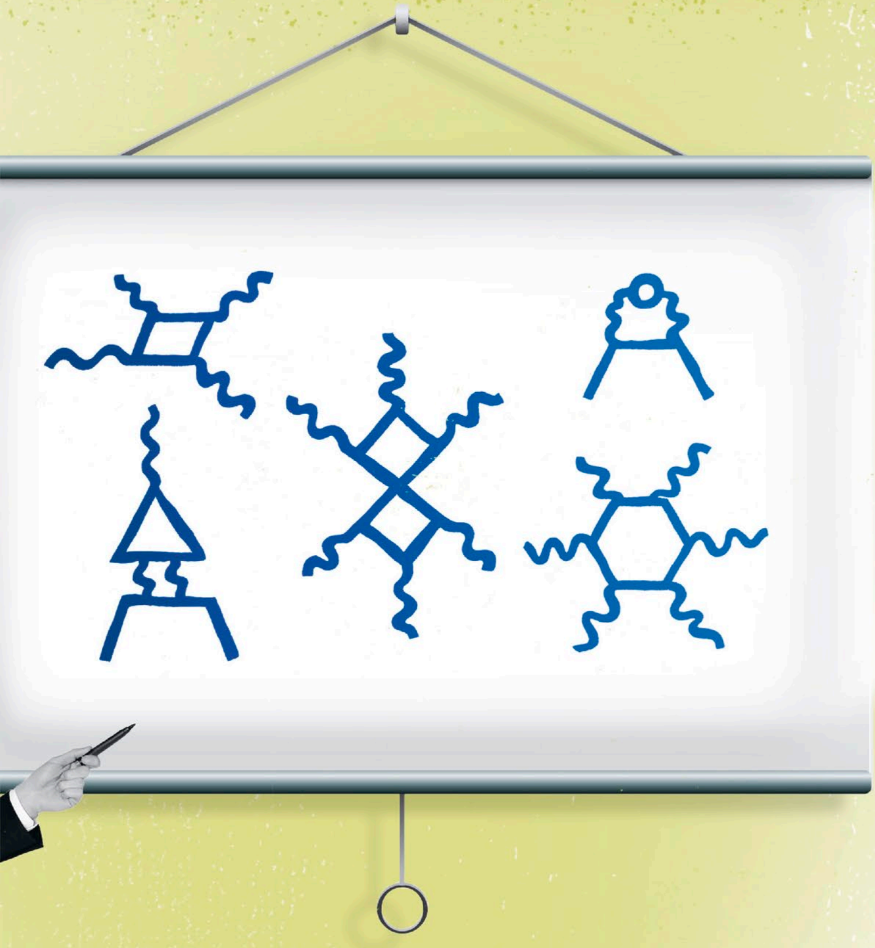

MADE GROUP LEADER IN THE THEORETICAL DIVISION AT LOS ALAMOS AGED 24

ACCURATELY DESCRIBED PARTICLE INTERACTIONS TO 15 DECIMAL PLACES

Feynman diagrams *depict the most abstract concepts in physics but look like charming squiggles. Feynman even decorated his yellow RV with them. Their simplicity reflects Feynman's flair for explaining complex ideas—his series of physics lectures at the California Institute of Technology (Caltech) was made into a textbook that proved extremely popular.*

MURRAY **GELL-MANN**

With wide-ranging talents, including languages, abstract thinking, and particle physics, Murray Gell-Mann was able to conceive the modern system for classifying subatomic particles.

In 1964, American polymath Gell-Mann (1929–) proposed a model for classifying the different types of subatomic particles. He distinguished two main groups of particles: fermions, the building blocks of matter; and bosons, which are force-carriers. To create his model, he had invented a hypothetical fundamental unit he called the "quark." Quarks, which are a type of fermion, group together to form hadrons (protons and neutrons). A few years later, the quark was isolated using a particle accelerator, proving Gell-Mann's model correct. He won the 1969 Nobel Prize in Physics, and his model became what is now known as the "standard model."